

BEHAVIOUR (a property of how the model works)

Knowledge is frozen
and long-tail-thin

Stateless between calls

Sensitive to prompt
position and structure

Reasoning happens
in emitted tokens

Fluency is independent
of correctness

Attention is uneven
across the window

Samples probabilistically
— not deterministic

Writes left-to-right,
cannot revise

PIPELINE DESIGN RULE (what you build because of it)

Retrieve, don't recall:
RAG + tools for fresh facts

You own state: pass history,
summarise, store memory

Freeze prompt structure;
version it like code

Give room to think;
budget the effort per route

Never trust prose — force schema,
verify against a source

Instructions at the edges;
rerank and trim the middle

Validate + bounded retry;
pin params; cache; log seeds

Plan-then-write as two calls;
add a revise pass